early historians of the Jan Sangh and the RSS, Bruce Graham and Walter Andersen, agree that Mookerjee may have 'first wanted to see who would win the struggle for power within the Congress'.[28]

RSS pracharak Vasantrao Oke had been in touch with Mookerjee since 1949 on the idea of starting a new party. So was Sangh supremo M.S. Golwalkar. The ban on the RSS after Gandhi's murder (February 1948–12 July 1949) had just been lifted by the Government of India. Some of its younger leaders, especially in Punjab and Delhi, were pushing for the RSS to turn itself into a political party.[29] However, its constitution expressly forbade political participation. Gowalkar himself remained opposed to the idea, but he acknowledged the internal debate, saying, 'I do not know. After the ban has been lifted … they [RSS workers] can if they like convert the Sangh into a political body. I for myself cannot say anything. I am not a dictator. Personally, I am outside politics. But why should people drag us into politics? We are happy with them as politicians and ourselves as Swayamsevaks.'[30] While the RSS made up its mind on its future political course, its leaders were also 'keenly interested in the struggle' within the Congress.[31] Both Mookerjee and the RSS, in that sense, may have felt that they could work with a Congress that was led by a Hindu traditionalist—such as its Uttar Pradesh Congress Committee President Purshottam Das Tandon, who was also the speaker of the Legislative Assembly of India's most populous province—rather than Nehru.[32]

When Nehru Resigned, Trounced the Congress's Hindu Traditionalists on Mookerjee's Questions: The Fight for the Congress's Soul

The sequence of events is instructive. Soon after leaving the Nehru government, Mookerjee attended a large meeting of refugee groups in Delhi on 29 July 1950. He was welcomed at the Old Delhi railway station by crowds of Hindu-nationalist young men holding up banners like, 'We Do Not Want Nehru's Anti-Hindu and Cowardly Government' and 'NehruLiaquat Pact Murdabad' (Death to the Nehru–Liaquat Pact).[33] The anti-Nehru tenor of the conference,